

Artificial Intelligence in the Knowledge Economy

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github.com/amchavezunyen/ai-05-ide

Capability and autonomy are separate dimensions

Capability: z_{AI}

Which problems can the AI solve?

It determines whether AI is basic or advanced, whether firms use a nonautonomous AI, and whether autonomous AI creates winners at the bottom.

Autonomy: feasible roles

Can AI pursue production opportunities, or may it only advise humans?

It changes the AI's outside option, who captures team output, and whether available compute produces independently.

The trap. “Distribution depends on autonomy, not capability” collapses the model's two-dimensional taxonomy. Proposition 5 supplies a capability condition inside the autonomous regime.

Source: Ide and Talamà (2025), accepted manuscript v12.

Knowledge hierarchies before AI

One worker, one opportunity

Knowledge $z \in [0, 1]$, difficulty
 $x \sim U[0, 1]$:

$$\Pr(x \leq z) = z.$$

A worker asks for help with probability
 $1 - z$. Each question consumes $h \in (0, 1)$
units of solver time.

Equilibrium sorting:

$$W \preceq I \preceq S, \quad m : W \rightarrow S \text{ strictly increasing.}$$

Source: Ide and Talamàs (2025), accepted manuscript v12.

One solver, several workers

$$h n(z)(1 - z) = 1 \implies \boxed{n(z) = \frac{1}{h(1 - z)}}.$$

A solver of knowledge $s \geq z$ raises success on every
residual problem. More knowledgeable workers ask
fewer questions, so they expand the solver's span of
control.

The firm's problem determines wages

Human worker z , human solver s

$$\Pi_2^{nA}(s, z) = n(z)[s - w(z)] - w(s).$$

Zero profit gives

$$w(z) = s - \frac{w(s)}{n(z)}.$$

Worker pay equals match quality minus the solver's wage allocated across the team.

Source: Ide and Talamàs (2025), accepted manuscript v12.

Two sources of a wage change

$$\Delta w_L = \underbrace{(s_1 - s_0)}_{\text{match effect}} + \underbrace{\frac{q_0 - q_1}{n_L}}_{\text{share effect}}.$$

AI can worsen the worker's match while lowering the solver's claim on team output. The net sign need not be positive.

Autonomous AI has a productive outside option

An AI agent has capability $a \equiv z_{AI}$ and uses one unit of compute. Abundant compute implies that some AI produces independently:

$$\Pi_1^{AI} = a - r^A = 0 \implies \boxed{r^A = a}.$$

AI as solver

$$n(z)[a - w^A(z)] - a = 0$$

$$\boxed{w^A(z) = a[1 - h(1 - z)]}.$$

AI as worker

$$n(a)[s - a] - w^A(s) = 0$$

$$\boxed{w^A(s) = n(a)(s - a)}.$$

Source: Ide and Talamàs (2025), accepted manuscript v12.

Basic and advanced AI reorganize work differently

Basic AI: $a \in \text{int } W$

$$W^* \subset W, \quad S^* \supset S.$$

AI is a relatively cheap routine worker. Demand for human solvers rises. Humans who remain workers receive worse solver matches.

Advanced AI: $a \in \text{int } S$

$$W^* \supset W, \quad S^* \subset S.$$

AI is a relatively cheap solver. Demand for human workers rises. The least knowledgeable workers can obtain a better match.

Propositions 3–4 connect occupations to wages. They determine the match effect that enters Proposition 5.

Source: Ide and Talamàs (2025), accepted manuscript v12.

Proposition 5: capability governs bottom gains

Define winners below and above the AI's knowledge:

$$B = \{z \in [0, a] : w^A(z) > w(z)\}, \quad T = \{z \in [a, 1] : w^A(z) > w(z)\}.$$

Bottom

$$B \neq \emptyset \iff a > \bar{z}_{AI}, \quad \bar{z}_{AI} \in \text{int } W.$$

Basic AI can generate a negative match effect. The bottom gains only when capability is high enough for the share effect to dominate.

Key condition. The existence of bottom winners is a statement about AI capability, even though Proposition 5 already holds autonomy fixed.

Source: Ide and Talamàs (2025), accepted manuscript v12.

Top

$$T \neq \emptyset \quad \forall a \in [0, 1].$$

The positive share effect dominates under the maintained $h < h_0$. The source notes that this can fail for $h \geq h_0$ or $a = 1$.

A discrete threshold reproduces the two cases

For a bottom worker $z = 0$ directly assisted by autonomous AI,

$$w^A(0) = a(1 - h).$$

With $h = 1/2$ and the paper's pre-AI $w(0) \approx 0.35704365$,

$$w^A(0) > w(0) \iff a > \frac{w(0)}{1 - h} \approx \boxed{0.71408730}.$$

Capability a	Autonomous bottom wage $a/2$	Verdict
0.425	0.2125	bottom loses
0.850	0.4250	bottom gains

Boundary of the calculation. This is a two-type direct-assistance analogue. It illustrates the capability threshold but does not derive the continuum model's endogenous $\bar{z}_{AI}$.

Source: Ide and Talamàs (2025), accepted manuscript v12.

Proposition 6: nonautonomous AI changes incidence

Nonautonomous AI may advise humans but cannot pursue production opportunities. Abundant idle compute implies $r^N = 0$.

Activation condition

$a \leq w(0) \Rightarrow$ AI unused,

$a > w(0) \Rightarrow$ bottom types use AI.

A nonautonomous AI still needs enough capability to be worth using.

Comparisons

1. Autonomous output is strictly higher.
2. Nonautonomous AI creates some losers.
3. Near the bottom, nonautonomous wages are weakly highest.
4. Near the top, autonomous wages are weakly highest.

Strict wage statements use the proposition's activation and type conditions.

Source: Ide and Talamàs (2025), accepted manuscript v12.

Nonautonomy raises bottom pay but leaves output idle

Worker assisted by AI

$$n(z)[a - w^N(z)] - 0 = 0 \Rightarrow w^N(z) = a.$$

$$w^N(z) - w^A(z) = ah(1 - z) > 0.$$

Strict for $a > 0$, $h > 0$, $z < 1$, and economically active when $a > w(0)$.

Otherwise idle compute

Let Q_H be common human-related output and $k > 0$ remaining compute:

$$Q^N = Q_H, \quad Q^A = Q_H + ka.$$

$$Q^A - Q^N = ka > 0.$$

Nonautonomy removes the productive worker role.

Source: Ide and Talamà (2025), accepted manuscript v12.

What I did analytically and computationally

Hand and algebra

- ▶ Derived $n(z) = 1/[h(1 - z)]$ from the solver's time constraint.
- ▶ Decomposed a worker wage change into match and share effects.
- ▶ Derived the discrete capability threshold.
- ▶ Derived the autonomy wage and output gaps.

Reproducible checks

- ▶ Recomputed $w(0) \approx 0.35704365$ from the paper's uniform example.
- ▶ Verified the 0.425 and 0.85 cases with a standard-library Python script.
- ▶ Formalized five discrete claims in Lean 4/Mathlib.
- ▶ Ran the paper-scoped AppliedModelingLib check before copying the Lean folder.

Claim boundary. None of these checks substitutes for the paper's continuum existence, matching, or neighborhood arguments.

Lean scope: a transparent discrete analogue

Lean verifies

- ▶ capability threshold equivalence;
- ▶ nonautonomous bottom-wage advantage;
- ▶ strict output gain from otherwise idle compute;
- ▶ match/share decomposition.
- ▶ positivity of span of control on the model domain.

Lean does not verify

- ▶ continuum equilibrium existence or uniqueness;
- ▶ occupational sets and matching maps;
- ▶ equality with the paper's endogenous threshold;
- ▶ the full top and bottom neighborhood claims.

Why this boundary matters. A short proof of an explicit algebraic analogue is stronger evidence than code that hides the equilibrium theorem in an assumption or a theorem named after the paper.

Required Lean slide: the capability threshold

1. Mathematical claim

$$w^A(0) = a(1 - h), \quad w^A(0) > w_0 \iff a > \frac{w_0}{1 - h}, \quad 0 < h < 1.$$

2. Lean statement

```
def bottomCapabilityThresholdSpec : Prop :=  
  ∀ a h w0 : ℝ,  
    0 < h -> h < 1 ->  
      autonomousAssistedWage a h 0 > w0 <->  
        a > capabilityThreshold w0 h
```

Most relevant proof step

```
have hden : 0 < 1 - h := sub_pos.mpr hh1  
unfold autonomousAssistedWage capabilityThreshold  
simp only [sub_zero, mul_one]  
constructor  
· exact fun hgain =>  
  (div_lt_iff0 hden).2 hgain  
· exact fun hcap =>  
  (div_lt_iff0 hden).1 hcap
```

3. What Lean represents

a : AI capability; h : helping cost; w_0 : pre-AI bottom wage. The strict domain $0 < h < 1$ makes $1 - h$ positive, so division preserves the inequality direction.

What Lean verifies

Exactly the equivalence in the displayed discrete model, including the nonzero positive denominator. It does not identify this threshold with the paper's continuum $\bar{z}_{AI}$.

Build/check: see

`lean/docs/CHECK_FAST_OUTPUT.txt`.

Where I did not believe the AI

Add the real photograph of the two-page hand derivation here.

Claim challenged

A cold summary said that the distributional result is driven by autonomy, not capability.

Hand check

The zero-profit equations give

$$w^A(0) > w_0 \iff a > \frac{w_0}{1-h}.$$

At $h = 1/2$, $a = 0.425$ is below the discrete threshold while $a = 0.85$ is above it.

Verdict. The one-line summary is incomplete. Capability determines whether there are winners at the bottom in Proposition 5. Autonomy changes incidence and output in Proposition 6. Both dimensions matter.